

## Erbium

68  
**Er**

Compounds of erbium are used to create pink tints for glass and pottery. Crystals containing this metal can boost laser signals travelling through long-distance Internet cables.

**ATOMIC MASS** 167.259

**STATE** Solid

### DISCOVERY

1843 (Carl Gustav Mosander)

**Laboratory sample of pure erbium**



## Lutetium

71  
**Lu**

The final member of the lanthanide group is also the densest. It is mainly used to break up complex chemicals in crude oil into smaller and more useful substances.



**Laboratory sample of pure lutetium**

**ATOMIC MASS** 174.967

**STATE** Solid

**DISCOVERY** 1907 (Georges Urbain), 1907 (Charles James), 1907 (Carl Auer von Welsbach)

## Ytterbium

70  
**Yb**

This metal reacts with oxygen in the air, so is stored in sealed containers. Pure ytterbium has several uses, including the strengthening of steel.

**ATOMIC MASS** 173.045

**STATE** Solid

**DISCOVERY** 1878 (Jean Charles Galissard de Marignac)

*Ytterbium is easy to hammer into thin sheets.*

**Laboratory sample of pure ytterbium**

